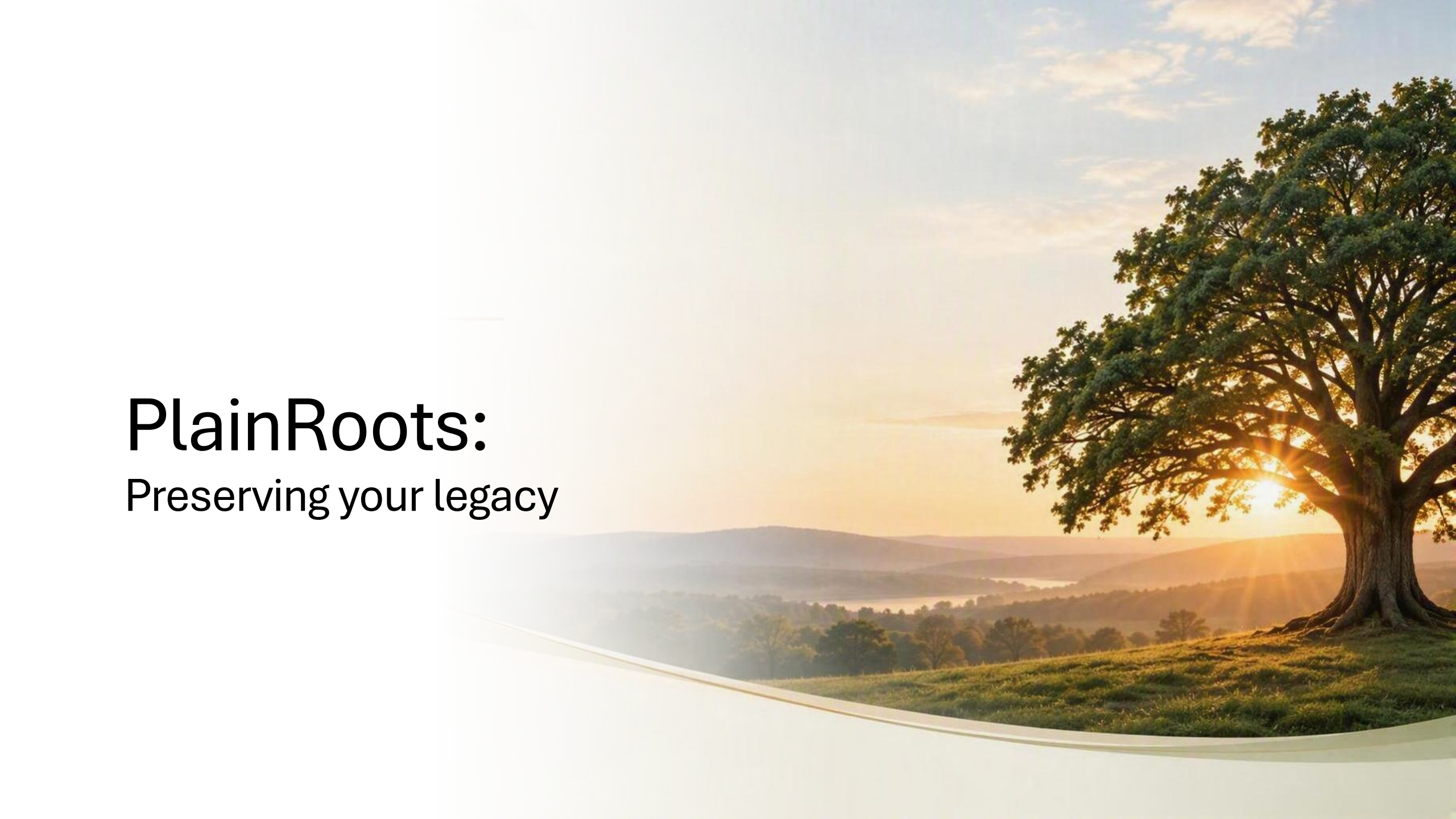
PlainRoots:

Preserving your legacy



PlainRoots

Why?

- Imagine spending months on your Genealogy tree, only to find out that:
  - The company that built the software no longer exists, and there is no way to view/export your data.
  - The data was stored in their cloud, and hackers took it for ransom.
  - Your logon credentials are lost, with no good recovery mechanism.

- It may not happen to you, but it could happen to your children, *or their children*.
  - BTW, did you leave your software / laptop login in your will?

PlainRoots

An archive built for generations

- All information is saved in plain text that can be read with any text editor— no pointers, flags that need decoding, etc.

- Can be shared with multiple family members as a private GitHub repository, strengthening preservation and enabling collaboration workflows such as Pull Requests.

- Built-in import/export to GEDCOM, the defacto Genealogy standard, enabling interoperability with platforms such as WikiTree.

PlainRoots

Enabling AI-accelerate research

- File layout was designed with AI in mind.
  - At best, existing solutions rely on GEDCOM for interoperability, storing all genealogy data in a single file that can grow indefinitely over time, making AI-driven parsing, analysis, and updates increasingly expensive.
  - PlainRoots stores each person in its own file, making parsing and updates significantly more efficient.

- PlainRoots includes 12 AI Skills that can help you become an expert Genealogist from Day 1.

- These work well on frontier models, but also on the models offered in free GitHub plans.

PlainRoots

Sample Json


```
{
  "id": "elena-lopez-martin",
  "name": "Elena López Martín",
  "givenNames": "Elena",
  "surnames": "López Martín",
  "sex": "female",
  "maidenName": null,
  "initials": "ELM",
  "occupation": "Librarian",
  "birthDate": "1944-09-08",
  "birthPlace": "Madrid, Spain",
  "deathDate": "2020-01-15",
  "deathPlace": "Guadalajara, Jalisco, Mexico",
  "lifeStatus": "deceased",
  "remarks": "The fictional sample story says that she moved from Madrid to Guadalajara as a young adult.",
  "researchNotes": "Fictional example created to demonstrate a Spanish birthplace and a translated migration narrative.",
  "photo": null
}
```

PlainRoots

How PlainRoots AI Skills can help?

1. Automatic translation of all data to chosen locales—*I can quickly share findings with my family in the U.S. and in Mexico!*
2. Writing text messages, emails, and letters to other family members, institutions, and civil authorities, in any language.—*Helps with languages I don't speak or are fluent in*.
3. Assisting with historical research—*Tell me what Spain was like in the 1920s*.
4. Validation of geography helps with locations that have changed names or countries over time, saving both the original and modern-day conventions.
5. Transcribing, translating, and extracting relevant facts from official documents.
6. Reasoning about conflicting evidence or incomplete information.
7. Establishing provenance for each fact and saving research notes for future generations.

PlainRoots

The cherry on the cake

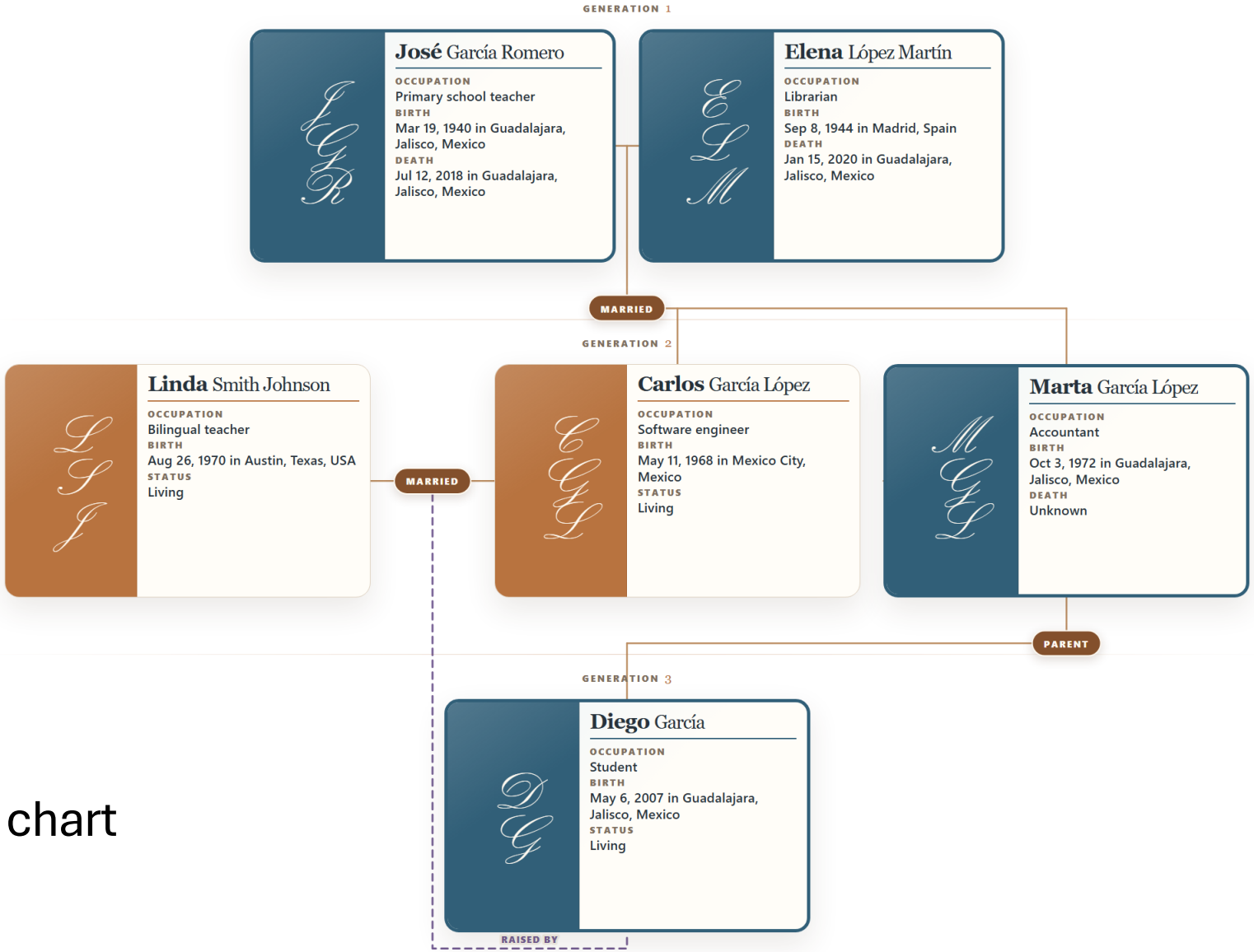
- Stories—Audio recordings can be saved, transcribed, and translated for future generations. It can also help you write a perfect story for generations to enjoy!
- Ability to extract portraits from group photographs.
- Multi-language, cross-generational support
  - Let’s say my children move to China, and their children want to read and extend the family tree. AI Skills support adding Mandarin as a repository language, automatically translating all existing content to Mandarin.
- Charts (JS + html) optimized for printing in Letter and A4 sizes—create beautiful genealogy albums for your family!

FICTIONAL REFERENCE ARCHIVE

Ancestry of Diego García

6 people across 3 generations

September 15, 2026



PlainRoots

Sample ancestry chart

PlainRoots

Sample person report with a story

DG

Diego García

Record ID	diego-garcia
Given names	Diego
Surnames	García
Occupation	Student
Birth	May 6, 2007
Birthplace	Guadalajara, Jalisco, Mexico
Status	Living

Modeled relationships

- **Parents:** Marta García López
- **Guardians:** Carlos García López, Linda Smith Johnson — Raised by from age 9 (family account)

Remarks

The fictional sample models Diego as living with his uncle and aunt from age nine.

Research notes and provenance

Fictional example: the raised-by relationship is attributed to a mock family account and remains separate from biological parentage.

Stories

Ice cream in the park

Original language: es-MX

One warm Saturday afternoon, I walked through the neighborhood park with my uncle Carlos and my aunt Linda. We stopped at an ice cream cart near the fountain. I chose strawberry, Linda chose vanilla, and Carlos chose chocolate.

On the way home, we laughed because the ice cream was melting faster than we could eat it. It was a simple afternoon, but I remember feeling happy to be together.

Story text `people/diego-garcia/story-ice-cream-in-the-park-en-us.md`